

improving the game. However, don't show it to too many people as this may confuse you about the quality of your game.

If you're into graphics, you can even design game levels, or if you prefer modelling try designing 3D models that can be showcased on your Web site or sent on a CD to the company you want to entice. Another popular course is to make maps and mods for games such as *Quake*, *Half-Life* and *Unreal Tournament* to gain an understanding of aspects such as level design, texture design and 3D-modelling techniques.

Breaking free

How do you go about establishing contacts and making forays into the gaming world? Here's what you need to do. Keep yourself updated with the latest trends in game development and upgrade your skills by downloading the various freeware tools from the Internet and by reading books. You can compile your game and send it to gaming companies on a CD or put it up on your personal Web site, if you have one, so that companies can check out your game.

When sending across your resume, remember that nothing speaks louder than experience. Companies like to look at the work you've done—the game(s) or levels you've developed. Customise your resume after doing some background research on the company. This will help you prepare your resume according to their requirements and area of expertise. Showcase skills such as communication and management abilities, etc, since they count a lot in this industry.

The most common path that aspirants take is to start their career as a play tester. This not only gives you a toehold in the industry but also gives you an opportunity to understand how the industry operates, as well as develop more contacts in the gaming arena. Contacts are a major driving force in your game development career. Make sure you have the right contacts if you want to succeed.

The opportunities

While the future of the gaming development industry in India may look bleak at present, there are opportunities coming up in the near future. Already, gaming for handhelds and mobile phones is becoming quite popular. So, if you hold the dream within you, keep it burning as by the time you acquire all the necessary skill sets, this industry is going to be ready with enough opportunities.

If you have visions of making it really big in game development overseas, then the UK is the place to head for. The UK is the hub of the gaming industry with almost all gaming majors having a presence there. Even Australia and New Zealand are picking up as off-shore development centres, and therefore, you get a wider scope to create some serious waves in the gaming industry.

Considering that we have some of the best and most cost-efficient programming manpower available, game developers from other countries may consider it worthwhile to outsource the job to Indian companies. Make the right moves, and in a couple of years you could be employed as a full-fledged game developer right here in *apna Bharat*. 

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Check it out for comprehensive programming resources

www.gamedev.net
This is yet another useful site for aspiring programmers

www.dperry.com
A thorough guide for game developing aspirants